002-14 Mui-Tsai 妹仔

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妹仔 (源自广东话，指在旧时中国南方家庭中，被卖到富人家庭做家务劳动的女孩)

Many of the girls and women in Hong Kong were mui-tsai (“little sisters”) who had been sold (v.) to wealthier families /through an intermediary (n.a.)中间人；中介者 known as a *pocket 口袋 mother*.

Found (v.) throughout China *under a variety of names*, this arrangement helped (v.) poor families find *better homes* for their daughters, while **providing** (v.) domestic 家庭的；家务的 help **for** wealthier families.

这种安排在中国各地有多种名称，它帮助贫困家庭为女儿找到更好的归宿，同时也为富裕家庭提供了家务帮助。

Although Hong Kong’s first ordinance 法令；条例, passed in 1844, 谓 banned (v.)禁止；取缔 slavery 奴隶制, **neither** the colonial government **nor** the majority of the Chinese population 谓 considered this to include (v.) the mui-tsai.

Despite some *sporadic (a.)零星的；偶尔的 criticism* 批评；指责 后定说明 mainly from missionaries 传教士 in Hong Kong and officials in Britain, 主 the legal status of the system 谓 did not **come into question** 受到质疑 until the late 1870s.

Example 1. 案例

Many of the girls and women in Hong Kong were mui-tsai (“little sisters”) who had been sold to wealthier families through an intermediary known as a pocket mother.
Found throughout China under a variety of names, this arrangement helped poor families find better homes for their daughters, while providing domestic help for wealthier families.
Although Hong Kong’s first ordinance, passed in 1844, banned slavery, neither the colonial government nor the majority of the Chinese population considered this to include the mui-tsai.
Despite some sporadic criticism, mainly from missionaries in Hong Kong and officials in Britain, the legal status of the system did not come into question until the late 1870s. 香港许多女孩和妇女都是“小妹”，她们通过被称为“口袋妈妈”的中间人被卖给富裕家庭。这种制度在中国各地都有，名称各异，它既帮助贫困家庭为女儿找到更好的归宿，又为富裕家庭提供家政服务。尽管香港于 1844 年颁布的第一部法令禁止奴隶制，但殖民政府和大多数中国民众都认为该法令并不包括 “小妹”制度。 尽管偶尔会有一些批评的声音，主要来自香港的传教士和英国官员，但直到 19 世纪 70 年代末，这一制度的合法性才受到质疑。

主 The reason that *the mui-tsai 妹仔；指旧中国被贩卖为仆役的女童 issue (n.)* ***became*** *(v.) so controversial* 有争议的；引起争论的 谓 **had much to do with** 与…… 有很大关系 timing 时机；时间安排.

By the late 1870s, an extensive 广阔的；广泛的；大规模的 network of kidnapping 谓 had developed **to feed** (v.) the need for prostitutes and servants in Hong Kong.

到19世纪70年代末，一个广泛的绑架网络已经发展起来，以满足香港对妓女和仆人的需求。

Girls were kidnapped from their native 出生地的；本土的 villages in China /and then sold in Hong Kong.

With the opening of the Suez Canal 苏伊士运河 in 1869, the colony was becoming *a popular destination* for European and American tourists 旅行者；游客, many of whom were shocked that /such a practice **could be tolerated** in a British colony.

The Victorian 维多利亚时代的 traveler Isabella Bird **described** (v.) the mui-tsai system **as** *a "peculiar 独特的；异常的；特有的 hateful 可恨的；令人讨厌的；可恶的 form* (n.) of slavery /which is recognised (v.) by Chinese custom, and which **has attained (v.) gigantic proportions** 规模；大小；比例 in Victoria."

The issue 问题；议题 had also attracted (v.) the attention of *reformist (a.)改良主义的；改革派的 groups* in Britain, such as *the Anti-Slavery Society* 反奴隶制协会 and *the Society for the Protection of Aborigines* 土著居民；原住民.

Example 2. 案例
Aborigine

1.a member of a race of people who were the original people living in a country 原住居民；土著；土人
2.Aboriginea member of the race of people who were the original people of Australia 澳大利亚土著

→ Ab：意为"从…"（from）+ Origine：意为"开始、起源、源头"（origin, beginning）

In California, American politicians 政治家；政客 used (v.) evidence of the mui-tsai to support (v.) *restricting (v.) Chinese immigration to the United States*.

Furthermore, local Chinese elites **had become strong enough** to protect (v.) a time-honored (a.)由来已久的；历史悠久的；因古老而受到尊重的 Chinese custom *from which they benefited* (v.).

In November 1878, 主 four prominent 著名的；杰出的；显著的 Chinese merchants — including Fung Ming Shan, a founder 创始人；创立者 of the *Nam Pak Hong Kung So* 南北行公所— 谓 petitioned (v.)请愿；请求；上诉 Governor Hennessy for permission **to form (v.) an agency** to stop (v.) the kidnapping of children from Dongguan 东莞, the four merchants' *native district* (地区；区域；行政区)故乡 in Guangdong.

1878年11月，四位杰出的中国商人——包括南白商行的创始人 Fung Ming Shan ——向总督轩尼诗请愿，要求成立一个机构，以阻止从东莞（这四位商人在广东的家乡）绑架儿童的行为。

Example 3. 案例

The reason that the mui-tsai issue became so controversial had much to do with timing. By the late 1870s, an extensive network of kidnapping had developed to feed the need for prostitutes and servants in Hong Kong.
Girls were kidnapped from their native villages in China and then sold in Hong Kong.
With the opening of the Suez Canal in 1869, the colony was becoming a popular destination for European and American tourists, many of whom were shocked that such a practice could be tolerated in a British colony.
The Victorian traveler Isabella Bird described the mui-tsai system as a "peculiar hateful form of slavery which is recognised by Chinese custom, and which has attained gigantic proportions in Victoria." 21 The issue had also attracted the attention of reformist groups in Britain, such as the Anti-Slavery Society and the Society for the Protection of Aborigines.
In California, American politicians used evidence of the mui-tsai to support restricting Chinese immigration to the United States.
Furthermore, local Chinese elites had become strong enough to protect a time-honored Chinese custom from which they benefited.
In November 1878, four prominent Chinese merchants—including Fung Ming Shan, a founder of the Nam Pak Hong Kung So—petitioned Governor Hennessy for permission to form an agency to stop the kidnapping of children from Dongguan, the four merchants' native district in Guangdong. 梅妾问题之所以引发如此大的争议，很大程度上与时机有关。到了 19 世纪 70 年代末，为了满足香港对妓女和佣人的需求，一个庞大的绑架网络已经形成。女孩们从中国农村被绑架，然后被贩卖到香港。随着 1869 年苏伊士运河的开通，香港逐渐成为欧美游客的热门目的地，许多游客震惊于这种做法竟然会在英国殖民地被容忍。维多利亚时代的旅行家伊莎贝拉·伯德将梅妾制度描述为"一种奇特的、令人憎恶的奴隶制形式，它被中国习俗所认可，并在维多利亚州达到了惊人的规模。" 21 这个问题也引起了英国改革派团体的关注，例如反奴隶制协会和原住民保护协会。在美国加利福尼亚州，一些政客利用梅妾的证据来支持限制华人移民美国的政策。此外，当地华人精英势力日益强大，足以维护一项他们从中获益的古老习俗。1878 年 11 月，包括南白鸿公社创始人之一冯明山在内的四位华人商人向总督轩尼诗请愿，请求成立一个机构，制止从东莞（这四位商人的故乡）拐卖儿童的现象。

In October 1879, Chief Justice 首席法官 John Smale **condemned** (v.) the mui-tsai practice **for** violating (v.) British and Hong Kong laws 后定说明 prohibiting (v.) slavery.

Smale estimated (v.) that /主 **between** ten thousand **and** twenty thousand girls 谓 were enslaved (v.)使成为奴隶；奴役 in Hong Kong.

"The more I penetrate (v.)刺入，穿透；深入了解；渗透 below *the polished (a.)抛光的；磨光的；擦亮的 surface* of our civilization," he declared, "the more convinced (a.)确信的；信服的 am I that 主 the broad under-current 潜流；暗流 of life here 系 is **more like** that *in the Southern States of the America* when slavery was dominant (a.)占主导地位的；盛行的, **than** it resembles (v.) *the all-pervading 遍布的；普遍的 civilization* of England."

我越是深入探究 (我们文明的) 光鲜表面之下，" 他宣称，"我就越确信 (这里 (指香港) 的) 广泛的生活暗流，更类似于 (美国南方各州的) 生活 (当时奴隶制占主导的)，而不是 (英格兰的) 那种无处不在的文明。

Example 4. 案例

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【主句】 he declared
│
└─ 【直接引语/宾语从句】 "The more..., the more..."
   │
   ├─ 【比较结构从句】 The more I penetrate (v.) below the polished surface of
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└─ 【比较结构主句】 the more convinced (a.) am I that...
    │
    ├─ 引导词：the more
    ├─ 表语：convinced
    ├─ 【谓语倒装】 am I
    │
    └─ 【宾语从句】 that `主` the broad under-current of life here `系` is r
        │
        ├─ 【表语比较结构】 more like..., than (it resembles (v.))...
        │   │
        │   ├─ 【比较对象A】 that in the Southern States of the Ame
        │   │   └─ 【定语从句】 when slavery was dominant
        │   │
        │   └─ 【比较对象B】 the all-pervading civilization of Engl
```

Table 1. “The more I penetrate below the polished surface of our civilization,” he declared, “the more convinced am I that /the broad under-current of life here is more like that in the Southern States of the America when slavery was dominant, than it resembles the all-pervading civilization of England.”

Header 1	Header 2
“The more I penetrate (v.) below *the polished surface of our civilization*,”	The polished surface of our civilization (我们文明的光鲜表面)，与下文“under-current (暗流)”形成对比
the more convinced am I that /the broad *under-current of life* here	• Under-current of life (生活的暗流) • The more convinced am I (我就越确信) 这是“the more..., the more...” 句型中主句的倒装结构。正常语序是“I am the more convinced”.
the broad under-current of *life* here is more like *that* (that指代前面的life) in the Southern States of the America when slavery was dominant, than it resembles the all-pervading civilization of England.	More like that..., than it resembles...(更类似于...，而不是它类似于...) 这是“more A than B” 的变体。A 是“like that...”(像那个)，B 是“resembles...”(类似于...)。

Smale’s attack caused (v.) a stir (n.)搅动，搅拌；激动（情绪），愤怒（情绪） among the Chinese community, and less than two weeks later 不到两周后 /a group of Chinese merchants **petitioned** (v.)请愿；请求 Governor Hennessy **for permission** to form (v.) an association 协会；社团 to protect kidnapped women and children.

After **reminding** (v.) Hennessy **of** Charles Elliot’s proclamation 公告；声明 of February 1841 后定说明 guaranteeing 保证；保障 Chinese in Hong Kong the right to practice (v.) their traditional customs, the petitioners 请愿者 **went to great lengths** 付出巨大努力,竭尽全力；不遗余力 to explain (v.) the difference between kidnapping and the mui-tsai system.

They also warned (v.) that /主 banning the system 谓 would lead (v.) even more 甚至更多,更加，更进一步 poor families in Guangdong to practice (v.) another traditional Chinese

custom: **drowning (v.)淹死；溺死 unwanted female babies** at birth 出生时.

Example 5. 案例

In October 1879, Chief Justice John Smale condemned the mui-tsai practice for violating British and Hong Kong laws prohibiting slavery.
Smale estimated that between ten thousand and twenty thousand girls were enslaved in Hong Kong.
"The more I penetrate below the polished surface of our civilization," he declared, "the more convinced am I that the broad under-current of life here is more like that in the Southern States of the America when slavery was dominant, than it resembles the all-pervading civilization of England." 22 Smale's attack caused a stir among the Chinese community, and less than two weeks later a group of Chinese merchants petitioned Governor Hennessy for permission to form an association to protect kidnapped women and children.
After reminding Hennessy of Charles Elliot's proclamation of February 1841 guaranteeing Chinese in Hong Kong the right to practice their traditional customs, the petitioners went to great lengths to explain the difference between kidnapping and the mui-tsai system. They also warned that banning the system would lead even more poor families in Guangdong to practice another traditional Chinese custom: drowning unwanted female babies at birth. 1879 年 10 月，首席大法官约翰·斯梅尔谴责 "梅仔" 制度违反了英国和香港禁止奴隶制的法律。斯梅尔估计，当时香港有 1 万至 2 万名女孩被奴役。他宣称："我越深入了解我们文明光鲜亮丽的表象之下，就越确信，这里生活的暗流更像是奴隶制盛行时期的美国南部各州，而不是无处不在的英国文明。" 22 斯梅尔的抨击在华人社区引起了轩然大波。不到两周后，一群华人商人向总督轩尼诗请愿，请求成立一个协会，以保护被绑架的妇女儿童。请愿者们提醒轩尼诗，查尔斯·艾略特曾于 1841 年 2 月颁布公告，保障香港华人享有传统习俗的权利。随后，他们竭力解释绑架和 "梅仔" 制度之间的区别。他们还警告说，禁止这种制度会导致广东更多贫困家庭实行另一种中国传统习俗：溺死刚出生的女婴。

Many people in Hong Kong felt that /Smale had unnecessarily condemned (v.) *a perfectly acceptable 完全可接受的, time-honored (a.) Chinese custom*.

Complicating (v.)使复杂化 matters 系 was *the ambiguous 模糊不清的；不明确的 status* of the mui-tsai *within 在...内部；在...范围之内 the adoptive (a.)收养的；领养的 household* 家庭；户 — half servant, half family member — **独立主格结构(做状语) with** 宾 some mui-tsai 宾补 even eventually *becoming (v.) concubines* 妾；姨太太 and *inheriting (v.)继承 their husbands' wealth*.

使事情复杂化的 (原因)，是妹仔在收养家庭内部的模糊地位 (这个地位是——半是仆人，半是家庭成员——)，(而且) 有一些妹仔甚至最终成为了妾室, 并继承了她们丈夫的财富。

Example 6. 案例
Complicating matters was the ambiguous status of the mui-tsai /within the adoptive household — 同位语/插入语 half servant, half family member— with 宾 some mui-tsai 宾补 even eventually becoming concubines and inheriting their husbands' wealth.

- the ambiguous status of the mui-tsai ***within** the adoptive household*
  within 意为 "在...内部；在...范围之内"。
  within the adoptive household 在收养家庭内部 / 在收养家庭的范围之内。
- **with + 宾语 (some mui-tsai) + 宾语补足语 (becoming... and inheriting...)构成一个"独立主格结构"，在句中作"状语"，补充说明前面主句的情况，**相当于一个并列分句，可理解为"而且，有些妹仔..."。

And 主 one of *the cardinal (a.)最重要的；基本的;红衣主教 rules* of British colonial administration 系 was that 主 **tampering (v.)篡改，擅自改动，胡乱摆弄（尤指有意破坏）too much** with native customs 谓 could be risky.

But critics 批评者；评论家 considered (v.) the system *a form of slavery* that often encouraged (v.) sexual abuse.

Defenders 捍卫者；辩护者, however, insisted 坚持认为 that /the girls **were treated as** family members /and that the system saved (v.) girls from prostitution 卖淫；娼妓业.

Example 7. 案例

Many people in Hong Kong felt that Smale had unnecessarily condemned a perfectly acceptable, time-honored Chinese custom.
Complicating matters was the ambiguous status of the mui-tsai within the adoptive household—half servant, half family member—with some mui-tsai even eventually becoming concubines and inheriting their husbands' wealth.
And one of the cardinal rules of British colonial administration was that tampering too much with native customs could be risky.
But critics considered the system a form of slavery that often encouraged sexual abuse.
Defenders, however, insisted that the girls were treated as family members and that the system saved girls from prostitution. 许多香港人认为，斯梅尔对一项完全合理且历史悠久的中国习俗进行了不必要的谴责。更复杂的是，梅菜在养父母家中的地位模糊不清——既是仆人，又是家庭成员——有些梅菜甚至最终成为妾室，继承丈夫的财产。英国殖民统治的一条重要原则就是，过度干预当地习俗可能会带来风险。但批评者认为，这种制度是一种奴隶制，常常助长性虐待。然而，支持者则坚称，这些女孩被视为家庭成员，而且这种制度使她们免于沦为娼妓。

By **asking for** permission **to form (v.) a society** to stop kidnapping, the Chinese elites were trying to distinguish (v.)区分；辨别 between kidnapping and the mui-tsai system, thus attempting to preserve (v.)保留；维护 a custom in which *they were 表 so heavily invested* (a.).

中国精英阶层请求获准建立一个制止绑架的社会，试图将"绑架"与"妹仔"制度区分开来，从而努力维护一种他们投入甚多的习俗。

Example 8. 案例
我问: 这里they were so heavily invested. 为什么有个 were? 难道是被动么? 为什么不写成 they invested so heavily ?

► DeepSeek:

Header 1	Header 2
这里是一个系表结构	这里的 were invested 并不是被动语态，而是一个"系动词 + 形容词" 结构，表示一种状态。 invested：是过去分词转化来的形容词，意思是"投入的、涉入很深的"。 • They were invested (a.). (他们投入很深。) 原句 a custom in which they were 表 so heavily invested (a.) 应理解为： 一种他们（的利益）深陷其中/与之深度绑定的习俗。 或更通顺地译为：一种他们与之利害攸关的习俗。

Header 1	Header 2
	这里的 were 是系动词，与形容词化的过去分词 invested 构成系表结构，**描述一种深度牵连的状态，而非被动语态，也非主动的“投资”行为。**
为什么不写成：they 谓 invested (v.) so heavily ?	这意为“他们主动地、在某个时间点投入了大量（金钱、精力等）”，**这描述的是一个"主动"的投资行为，而不是他们身处其中、与之利益捆绑的"持续状态"。**

► gemini:

这里的 be invested in 并不是我们常说的“被投资”，而**是一种形容词化的用法，**表示**“投入了巨大的心力/利益”或“深度参与/利益攸关”**。

表达方式	侧重点
They were 表 so heavily invested (a.) (状态)	**侧重于状态。**强调他们此时此刻正处于一种“泥足深陷”或“利益紧绑”的局面中。 这里用 were invested 是为了表达：这群精英阶层已经和这个制度（妹仔制度 mui-tsai）利益捆绑得太深了，他们已经身处其中，无法轻易脱身。
They 谓 invested (v.) so heavily (主动)	**侧重于动作。**强调他们“投入”了金钱或时间这个行为。

想象一下你开了一家奶茶店，不仅投了钱，还花了三年心血，连全家人的生计都指望它。

- 如果说 "I invested (v.) in the shop"，就像是在说：“我往店里投了钱。”（听起来只是个买卖）
- 如果说 "I am heavily invested (a.) in the shop"，意思就是：“这家店就是我的命，我跟它是一体的。”（这是一种深度绑定的状态）

你可以把它看作系表结构。

Their petition 请愿书；申诉书 was also a declaration 声明；宣称 that the Chinese elites had the wherewithal 财力；能力；手段;必要的资金（或手段） to handle (v.) the situation.

After a series of studies on *whether 是否 the system constituted (v.)构成；组成 slavery* 奴隶制, the matter **went to** the British *House of Lords* 上议院, which agreed that /the colonial government should not **interfere (v.)干涉；干预 with customs** that were 表 so deeply ingrained (a.)根深蒂固的;使根深蒂固 in Chinese society.

Example 9. 案例

我问: 这里 that **were so deeply ingrained** in Chinese society 中, ingrained 这个词既可以做动词, 也可以做形容词, 那么 were ingrained 是理解成"被动句"好, 还是理解成 "系表结构"好? 理由是什么?

注意: 对此, 几个AI的看法是不同的:

- 认为是系表的: gemini, grok, (我自己也偏向于系表),
- 原先认为是被动, 但被我质疑`后, 就改变了原先的观点, 而改成系表的的: ChatGPT, DeepSeek

Header 1	Header 2
▸ grok:	(1). “deeply ingrained” 是固定搭配，几乎总是形容词用法. 又如: “deeply ingrained habit / prejudice / belief / custom / tradition” “deeply ingrained in Chinese society / in our culture / in his character” **这个结构在现代英语里出现频率极高，母语者几乎不会把它理解成被动语态。** (2). **更重要的是，英国上议院讨论的重点不是“某人把习俗刻进了中国社会”，而是“这些习俗在中国社会里已经根深蒂固到难以撼动”的 状态。** (3). 语法测试（很直观的方法） 可以把句子做以下替换测试，看是否自然： • 原句部分：customs that were so deeply *ingrained* → 把 ingrained 换成其他更明显的形容词, 我们来看看句子意思是否合理: • customs that were so deeply *rooted (a.)根深蒂固的；生根的 / entrenched (a.)根深蒂固的；确立的，不容易改的 / established* (a.)确立已久的，早已投入使用的 替换后, 意思也完全自然. → 能顺畅替换成其他形容词 → 说明原句本身就是系表结构. → 再替换成更明显的被动结构: • customs that **were so deeply implanted / instilled / embedded** by someone 不自然，语义变了 • customs that **had been so deeply ingrained** 勉强，但很别扭
▸ gemini:	在这个句子中，**作者并不是想表达“某人”在那个瞬间把习俗“植入”了社会，而是描述这些习俗已经存在了很久、已经成为了社会DNA的一部分。**ingrained 在这里修饰 customs，描述其“不可磨灭”的属性。
▸ ChatGPT:	如果是纯形容词，通常会： - 不带典型动词搭配 - 不明显体现“被谁做” • 如果是动作型被动，通常更自然的是：had been ingrained 因为“被植入”是一个先发生的动作。 • 但这里用 simple past “were”，更符合：描述当时存在的状态 **英语里大量 V-ed 结构处于一个“灰色地带”**： The door is closed.（状态） The door was closed.（可能是动作，也可能是状态） **区分关键永远是：语境是否强调“发生了什么”，还是强调“处于什么状态”**

In 1880 /Hennessy approved (v.) the Chinese merchants’ plan, and the *Po Leung Kuk* 保良局 (Society 社团，协会 for *the Protection of Women and Children*) was officially opened (v.) in August 1882.

1880年，轩尼诗批准了中国商人的计划，保良局（保护妇女和儿童协会）于1882年8月正式成立。

The Colonial Office 殖民事务部 eventually decided that /主 the only thing necessary 系 was **to ensure (v.) that** /the mui-tsai were not being sold (v.) into prostitution 卖淫；娼妓业, passing (v.) an ordinance 法令；条例 to this effect 为此目的；在这个意义上 in 1887.

Example 10. 案例

By asking for permission to form a society to stop kidnapping, the Chinese elites were trying to distinguish between kidnapping and the mui-tsai system, thus attempting to preserve a custom in which they were so heavily invested.
Their petition was also a declaration that the Chinese elites had the wherewithal to handle the situation.
After a series of studies on whether the system constituted slavery, the matter went to the British House of Lords, which agreed that the colonial government should not interfere with customs that were so deeply ingrained in Chinese society.
In 1880 Hennessy approved the Chinese merchants' plan, and the Po Leung Kuk (Society for the Protection of Women and Children) was officially opened in August 1882.
The Colonial Office eventually decided that the only thing necessary was to ensure that the mui-tsai were not being sold into prostitution, passing an ordinance to this effect in 1887. 通过请求成立一个制止拐卖的社团，中国精英试图区分拐卖和嫔妃制度，从而维护他们深耕多年的传统习俗。他们的请愿也表明，中国精英有能力处理此事。在对嫔妃制度是否构成奴隶制进行了一系列研究之后，此事提交至英国上议院。上议院一致认为，殖民政府不应干预根深蒂固于中国社会的习俗。1880 年，亨尼西批准了中国商人的计划，保良局（妇女儿童保护协会）于 1882 年 8 月正式成立。殖民地事务部最终认定，唯一需要做的就是确保嫔妃不被卖入妓院，并于 1887 年颁布了相关法令。

Especially compared to the movement to end (v.) the mui-tsai system after World War I, 主 the debate in the late 1870s and the early 1880s 系 was short-lived 短暂的；持续时间短的 and confined (v.)限制；使局限于 mainly within Hong Kong.

Nor did *the debate* and *the subsequent (a.) establishment* of the Po Leung Kuk 谓 **lead to** *any significant changes* to the mui-tsai system.

Example 11. 案例

当使用 Nor 或 Neither 在句首来表示“（前者不）…，（后者也）不…”时，句子必须进行部分倒装，即把助动词/情态动词/系动词提到主语之前。

倒装结构：Nor + 助动词 (did) + 主语 (the debate and…) + 谓语动词原形 (lead)…

它通常接在前一个否定句之后。
在你的句子中，**“Nor” 引导的倒装句强烈暗示，前面应该已经陈述了某件事“没有”导致妹仔制度的改变。**而这句话则在补充说明：“（而且，）辩论和保良局的成立，同样也没有带来任何重大改变。”

Although Hennessy hoped that /the *Po Leung Kuk* would end (v.) the practice, some critics 批评者；评论家 considered the society *a clever scheme* for **ensuring that** /wealthy Chinese families always had a steady 稳定的；持续的 supply of young servants /**and that** wealthy Chinese men had *a pool 一批；一群 of* potential concubines 妾；妃子.

As Elizabeth Sinn **argues**, 主 the Chinese merchants' "triumph 谓 had long-term consequences."

Despite its many *commendable (a.)值得称赞的；值得表扬的 charitable (a.)慈善的；施舍的 and philanthropic 慈善的；博爱的 activities*, the Po Leung Kuk upheld (v.)维持；维护；支

持 a “peculiarly 特别地；独特地 Chinese form of patriarchy 父权制；家长统治 *at a critical point* of its development in Hong Kong.”

Once the controversy 争论；争议；辩论 had subsided (v.)平息；减弱；消退， “official inertia (n.)惰性；迟钝；不活动 **set in** 开始；来临 again,” and the mui-tsai system was left (v.) “unquestioned (a.)未受质疑的；无争议的” until 1917.

Example 12. 案例
inertia

(n.) 1.(usuallydisapproving) lack of energy; lack of desire or ability to move or change 缺乏活力；惰性；保守
•I can’t seem to throw off this feeling of inertia (n.). 我好像无法摆脱这种无力的感觉。
•the forces of *institutional inertia* (n.)制度惯性 in the school system 学校体制内的惰性

2.(physics 物)a property (= characteristic) of matter (= a substance) by which it stays still or, if moving, continues moving in a straight line unless it is acted on by a force outside itself 惯性

→ 来自inert,惰性的。后17世纪物理学家牛顿用来指物理学上的力的惯性。
in-,不，非，-ert,灵巧，技术，技艺，词源同 art,artisan.引申词义没技术的，没活动能力的，懒惰的，后用于指化学气体惰性的。

Sociologist 社会学家 Henry Lethbridge **concluded (v.) that** /*instead of* ending the system, the Po Leung Kuk “**helped**, indirectly 间接地， **to maintain (v.)** ***in servitude*** (n.)奴役（状况）；任人差遣（的状况） numbers of 数量众多 Chinese girls /until long after the First World War.”

社会学家亨利·莱斯布里奇得出结论，保良局非但没有终结这一制度，反而“间接地帮助维持了大量中国女孩的奴役状态，直至第一次世界大战后很长一段时间”。

Example 13. 案例
the Po Leung Kuk “helped, indirectly, **to maintain** ***in servitude*** numbers of Chinese girls /until long after the First World War.

这里, maintain (v.) in servitude numbers of girls 里面点倒装,
正常语序是：maintain (v.) numbers of Chinese girls 状态状语 *in servitude*
因为宾语(numbers of Chinese girls)太长，状语(in servitude)较短，所以把状语提前，宾语后置，避免头重脚轻。

Example 14. 案例
inertia

(n.) 1.(usuallydisapproving) lack of energy; lack of desire or ability to move or change 缺乏活力；惰性；保守
•I can’t seem to throw off this feeling of inertia (n.). 我好像无法摆脱这种无力的感觉。
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Example 15. 案例

Especially compared to the movement to end the mui-tsai system after World War I, the debate in the late 1870s and the early 1880s was short-lived and confined mainly within Hong Kong.
Nor did the debate and the subsequent establishment of the Po Leung Kuk lead to any significant changes to the mui-tsai system.
Although Hennessy hoped that the Po Leung Kuk would end the practice, some critics considered the society a clever scheme for ensuring that wealthy Chinese families always had a steady supply of young servants and that wealthy Chinese men had a pool of potential concubines.
As Elizabeth Sinn argues, the Chinese merchants' "triumph had long-term consequences." Despite its many commendable charitable and philanthropic activities, the Po Leung Kuk upheld a "peculiarly Chinese form of patriarchy at a critical point of its development in Hong Kong." Once the controversy had subsided, "official inertia set in again," and the mui-tsai system was left "unquestioned" until 1917.23 Sociologist Henry Lethbridge concluded that instead of ending the system, the Po Leung Kuk "helped, indirectly, to maintain in servitude numbers of Chinese girls until long after the First World War."24 与一战后废除嫔妃制度的运动相比，19 世纪 70 年代末 80 年代初的这场辩论持续时间很短，且主要局限于香港。这场辩论以及随后保良局的成立，也并未对嫔妃制度带来任何实质性的改变。尽管轩尼诗希望保良局能够终结这一陋习，但一些批评人士认为，保良局不过是确保富裕华人家庭始终拥有源源不断的年轻仆人，以及富裕华人男性拥有众多潜在妾室的巧妙手段。正如伊丽莎白·辛恩所言，华人商人的"胜利产生了深远的影响"。尽管保良局开展了许多值得称道的慈善活动，但它在香港发展的关键时期，却维护了一种"独特的中国式父权制"。争议平息后，"官方惯性再次出现"，女傩制度一直"未受质疑"地延续到 1917 年。 23 社会学家亨利·莱斯布里奇得出结论，保良局非但没有废除这一制度，反而"间接地帮助维持了大量中国女孩的奴役状态，直至第一次世界大战后很长一段时间"。 24